

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

Slow burns, no burns and missing help! Digit to the rescue again!

At Sixes And Sevens

Q Internet Explorer 6 does not open on my computer, even after my trying to reinstall it. I have Windows XP SP2.

Monitesh Thakur

A You can install Internet Explorer 7 from our December 2006 CD; IE7 is better than IE6, with features such as tabbed browsing, a phishing filter, and more. But if you must use IE6 for some reason, there are two ways you can repair it. We're mentioning both methods because the first may work while the second may not, or vice-versa.

First, keep your Windows XP CD ready. Then,

Method #1:

Go to **Start > Run**, type in "sfc /scannow" in the Run dialog box, and click OK. Note that there is a space between "sfc" and "/scannow". Follow the prompts throughout the System File Checker process that ensues. Reboot the computer when it is complete.

Method #2:

Go to **Start > Search**, and select "All Files and Folders". Select "More Advanced Options" and place a checkmark next to the "Search Hidden Files and Folders" option. Ensure that "Search System Folders" and "Search Subfolders" are also checked. In the "All or Part of the File Name" box, type in "ie.inf ". In the "Look In" drop-down, select C: (or the letter of the drive that contains the Windows folder). Click Search. In the search results pane, look at the ie.inf file located in the Windows\Inf folder. Right-click on this file and select Install from the context menu. Reboot when the file copy process is complete.

Partitions Going Poof!

Q I have a P IV 3 GHz on an Intel original 915GAV motherboard with Windows XP Pro SP2. I also have an 80 GB SATA hard drive and a DVD-ROM drive. I recently installed a 40 GB IDE hard drive as a primary slave, because there is only one IDE slot. The problem is that the partitions on this drive suddenly disappear from My Computer, and are visible only after I restart the computer.

Vivek Dembla

A It seems that the power connector of the IDE drive is faulty and needs to be replaced. This is a serious issue and needs to be remedied as soon as possible; it can cause permanent damage to your hard drive.

Of Insomnia And Amnesia

Q I have a P IV 2.66 GHz on an Intel original motherboard (D101GGC), with 512 MB of RAM and Windows XP Pro SP2. When I open the Power Options in the Control Panel, I see the Hibernate option greyed out. Also, when I run *Grand Theft Auto: Vice City*, I get an error message: "Grand Theft Auto VC: not enough memory."

Harpreet Singh

A It is clear that the drive where your Windows paging file and hibernate file exists does not have enough free space, and that you are therefore low on virtual memory, which is required by most applications to run properly. Free up space on this drive by deleting unnecessary files and/or moving data to another partition.

We recommend you remove the paging file completely from the drive where Windows is installed—place it on a different drive. Since you have 512 MB of RAM, we recommend a page file of 768 MB (both initial and maximum values).

On The Back-Burner

Q I have an Intel 915GAV motherboard with an Intel P IV 3.0 GHz processor, NVIDIA GeForce 6200, 1 GB RAM, and a 160 GB SATA hard drive. Is it possible to run Windows Vista on my computer? Also, I have a Sony DRU-820 DVD-Writer and an HP DVD 635 DVD-Writer. Burning a 4 GB DVD at 8x takes more than 20 minutes—why? I am running Windows XP SP2 and using Nero.

Amit Mukim

A As for your first question, it is indeed possible to install Vista on your computer; your system configuration meets the requirements.

There could be several reasons for the DVD-Writer taking this long to write. Check if your drive is operating using DMA mode. Open the Device Manager by running "devmgmt.msc". Under "IDE ATA/ATAPI Controllers", check the properties of all the channels, and in each case, check in the Advanced Tab whether the Transfer Mode is set to DMA or PIO. Set it to DMA if it is PIO. Then restart your PC. The next thing you should do is to check whether your C: drive has at least 5 GB of free space. If it doesn't, make some. If freeing up more than 5 GB is not possible, open Nero, select **File > Options**, and click on the Cache tab. Set the Cache location to a drive with at least 5 GB of free space.

When you burn a DVD, you should disable programs that run in the background, especially the anti-virus. You should also defragment your C: drive. If your problem persists, try using a different brand of recordable media. Update your drive's firmware as a last resort.

Am I Unwelcome?

Q I use Windows XP Professional. For the past few days, I have not been able to see the Welcome screen, and have to use the classic login. I want to enable Welcome screen so I can use Fast User Switching. I have tried changing the settings in User Accounts ("change the way users log in") in the Control Panel, but it didn't help.

Sunny Jha

Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!